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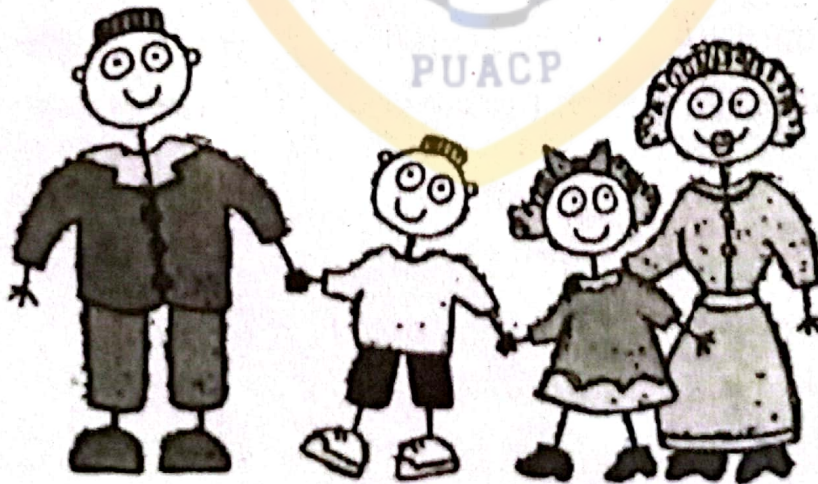
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SOCIALIZATION

INTRODUCTION

Inducting an individual into society is called socialization. It is a process of training to adjust man in society. Man is to live in various social groups and different social situations. He is to learn techniques of life to adjust himself in new modes of life. This learning of techniques of social life is called socialization. Learning of different behaviors in different social situations is the process of socialization.

An individual faces so many situations in his life. In every situation he is to play different role. For this purpose, learning the norms is necessary which enables him to do so. Role playing requires learning of norms for those social situations. This learning of norms is called socialization. The individual by learning social norms and playing different roles get experience of social life. Learning these experiences of social life is called socialization.



From the point of view of Lee and others, a personality is "the result of habit formation". Habits are individually repeated behaviors. A range of human experiences is introduced from the very life in childhood. Culture and society provide

the individual with institutionalized patterns of behavior for various stages of life so that he may become a functioning member of society. Learning cultural norms according to the development of age is the process of "socialization". This is a continuous process of life. The process whereby personality is acquired through social interaction is known as socialization.

Definition

Young and Mack observe, *"the process of inducting the individual into the social world is called socialization"*. In common-sense, socialization is a life-long training for the adjustment of one's life in society. This process of socialization is the process of learning norms, roles, techniques and other cultural patterns. In two ways, the processes of learning take places.

Peter Woeseley: *"process of transmission of culture, the process whereby men learn the rules and practices of social groups."*

John J. Maccionis: *"it's a lifelong social experience by which individuals develop their human potential and learn culture."*

Lundberg says: *"complex processes of interaction through which the individual learns the habits, beliefs, skills and standards of judgment that are necessary for his effective participation in social groups and communities."*

Horton and Hunt said: *"socialization is the process whereby one internalizes the norms of the groups among whom one lives so that a unique "self" emerge."*

Importance or Functions of Socialization:

1. Learning of social expectation: The process of socialization is important from the point of view of society as well as from the point of view of individual. Every society is faced with the necessity of making a responsible member out of each child born into it. The child must learn the expectations of the society so that his behavior can be relied upon.

2. Adoption of norms group life: Individual must acquire the group norms in order to take the behavior of others into account. Socialization means transmission

of culture the process by which men learn the rules and practices of social groups to which belongs. It is through it that a society maintains its social system, transmits its culture from generation to generation

3. Development of self: From the point of view of the individual, socialization is the process by which the individual learns social behavior, develops his self. Socialization plays a unique role in personality development of the individual. The self emerges and develop through the process of socialization. The self, the core of personality, develops out of the child's interaction with others.

4. Better personality development: It is the process by which the new born individual, as he or she grows up, acquires the values of the group and is molded into a social being. Without socialization, no individual can become a better person, because it (socialization) joins ideas, culture, capacities and needs of the human organism which turns into a better human society.

5. Adoption of culture and human skills: In the socialization process the individual learns the culture as well as skills, ranging from language to manual dexterity which will enable him to become a participating member of human society.

6. Discipline and training: Socialization inculcates basic disciplines, ranging from toilet habits to be a scientist. In his early years, individual is also socialized with regard to basic social life.

7. Transmission of culture: Socialization teaches skills. Only by acquiring needed skills individual fit into a society. In simple societies, traditional practices are handed down from generation to generation and are usually learned by imitation and practice in the course of everyday life. Socialization is indeed an intricate process in a complex society characterized by increasing specialization and division of work. In these societies, inculcating the abstract skills of literacy through formal education is a central task of socialization.

8. Acquisition of social roles and responsibilities: Another element in socialization is the acquisition of the appropriate social roles that the individual is expected to play. He knows role expectations, that is what behavior and values are a part of the role he will perform. He must desire to practice such behavior and pursue such ends. Role performance is very important in the process of socialization. As

males, females, husbands, wives, sons, daughters, parents, children, student's teachers and so on, accepted social roles must be learned if the individual is to play a functional and predictable part in social interaction.

9. Helps to control human behavior: It helps to control human behavior: An individual from birth to death undergoes training and his, behavior is controlled by numerous ways. In order to maintain the social order, there are definite procedures or mechanism in society. These procedures become part of the man's life and man gets adjusted to the society. Through socialization, society intends to control the behavior of its-members unconsciously.

TYPES OF SOCIALIZATION

There are four types of socialization which are given by Ian Robertson in his book sociology.

1. Primary socialization

This is the most essential and fundamental type of socialization. It takes place in the early years of newborn baby. At this stage, concentration is given on language and cognitive skills, the internalization of cultural norms and values, establishment of emotionality and appreciation of other roles and perspectives.

2. Anticipatory socialization

Individual not only learns the culture of his groups rather he also learns the cultures of groups to which he does not belong. Such a process whereby men socialize themselves into the culture of a group with the anticipation of joining that group is referred as anticipatory socialization by R.K. Merton.

3. Developmental Socialization

This kind of learning is based on the achievements of primary socialization. It builds on already acquired skills and knowledge as the adult progress through new situations such as marriage or new jobs. These require new expectations, obligations, and roles. This new learning combines with old skills makes possible developmental socialization.

4. Re-Socialization

Re-socialization takes places mostly when a social role is radically changed. It may

also happens during social mobility process. When new social roles emerged which are not compatible with the existing qualities and skills of individual, resocialization takes place. This phenomenon is generally found in old age population who is striving hard for their survival in changing world.

SOURCES/AGENCIES OF SOCIALIZATION

1. The Family

During the socialization process, the family is considered the most significant. There are some factors i.e., Broken home dissatisfaction of basic needs and unbalanced affection of the parents due to which socialization remains incomplete.

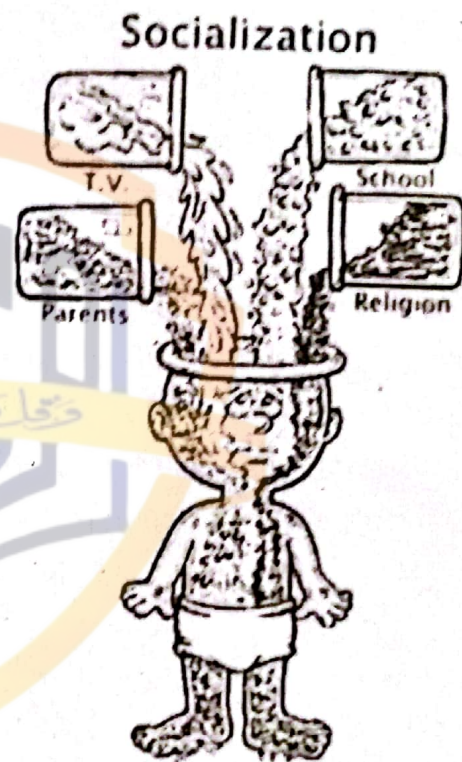
2. Peers or Age mates

'Peer groups' means those groups made up of the contemporaries of the child, his associates in school, in playground and in street. He learns from these children, facts and facets of culture that they have previously learnt at different times from their parents. The members of peer groups have other sources of information about the culture - their peers in still other peer groups - and thus the acquisition of culture goes on.

As time passes by of course, the peer group surpasses the parental and family groups in importance. It is true that the 'peer culture' becomes more important and effective than the 'parental culture' in the adolescent years of the child. The advice of one's agemates whether overtly or covertly communicated, sets the standards in almost every aspect of conduct. However, we should not assume that the socialization process is completed by the time the teen ages are reached. On the other hand, this is the time when pressures for conformity are perhaps, at their heights.

3. Social Institutions

The family, markets, mosque, madrasa of religious education, fairs, games and plays, cinema, theatre and national celebrations are the institutions of socialization. A



school is one of the socializing institutions of education. The school, college and university are the formal institutions of education. An individual learns his cultural norms, the values, beliefs, sentiments, habits, customs, rituals and other ways of life through these agencies of socialization. Education is itself a process of socialization. Education teaches the techniques of life to enable an individual to meet his needs of life. This is called socialization. It means socialization is done through these social institutions. Hence, the whole society is itself a learning group.

4. Literature and Mass Media of Communication

This is, of course, found only in literate societies and that is the literature. The civilization that we share is constructed of words or literature. "Words rush at us in torrent and cascade; they leap into our vision, as in billboard and newspaper, magazine and textbook; and assault our ears, as in radio and television". The media of mass communication give us their messages. These messages too contain in capsule form, the premises of our culture, its attitudes and ideologies. The words are always written by someone and these people too - authors and editors and advertisers join the teachers, the peers and the parents in the socialization process. In individual cases, of course, some of these influences are more important than others. The responses can also differ. "Some of us respect tradition; others fear the opinions of their peers, and still others prefer to listen to the 'thousand tongues' of conscience". But all modes of socialization result in conformity of a kind and all thus contribute to the transmission of a culture by some and its acquisition by others.

5. The Community

This is the biggest agency of socialization. A large number of agencies are available in a community which educates its members informally. Man learns ways of life and norms of society by participating in these agencies. He plays his roles in these agencies and gets experiences, which add to his information. This is his socialization in community.

SOCIALIZATION THROUGH THE LIFE COURSE

1. First Stage: Childhood

It starts from at birth age and ends upto 12 years.

Socialization continues throughout the several stages of the life course most

commonly categorized as childhood, adolescence, adulthood, and old age. This section sketches some important aspects of the major life course stages.

Despite increasing recognition of the entire life course, childhood (including infancy) certainly remains the most important stage of most people's lives for socialization and for the cognitive, emotional, and physiological development that is so crucial during the early years of anyone's life.

Beyond this basic importance of childhood, however, lies an ugly truth. In regard to education, health, and other outcomes, many children do not fare well during childhood. What happens during childhood can have lifelong consequences. Traumatic experiences during childhood—being neglected or abused, witnessing violence, being seriously injured, and so forth—put youngsters at much greater risk for many negative outcomes. They are more likely to commit serious delinquency during adolescence, and, throughout the life course, they are more likely to experience various psychiatric problems, learning disorders, and substance abuse.

2. Adolescence

According to WHO, An adolescent is any person between age 10-19 years.

Adolescence can be a very challenging time. Teenagers are no longer mere children, but they are not yet full adults. They want their independence, but parents and teachers keep telling them what to do. Peer pressure during adolescence can be enormous, and tobacco, alcohol, and other drug use become a serious problem for many adolescents.

These are all social aspects of adolescence, but adolescence also is a time of great biological change. Emotional (Romantic) relationships, including the desire to be in such a relationship, also matter greatly during adolescence. Wishful thinking, unrequited love, and broken hearts are common issues of this age. Friendship with deviant kinds of person may contribute to delinquency and substance abuse. Adolescence emerged as a buffer between childhood and adulthood. We generally link adolescence, or the teenage years, with emotional and social turmoil as young people struggle to develop their own identities. Again, we are tempted to attribute teenage rebelliousness and confusion to the biological changes of puberty.

3. Adulthood

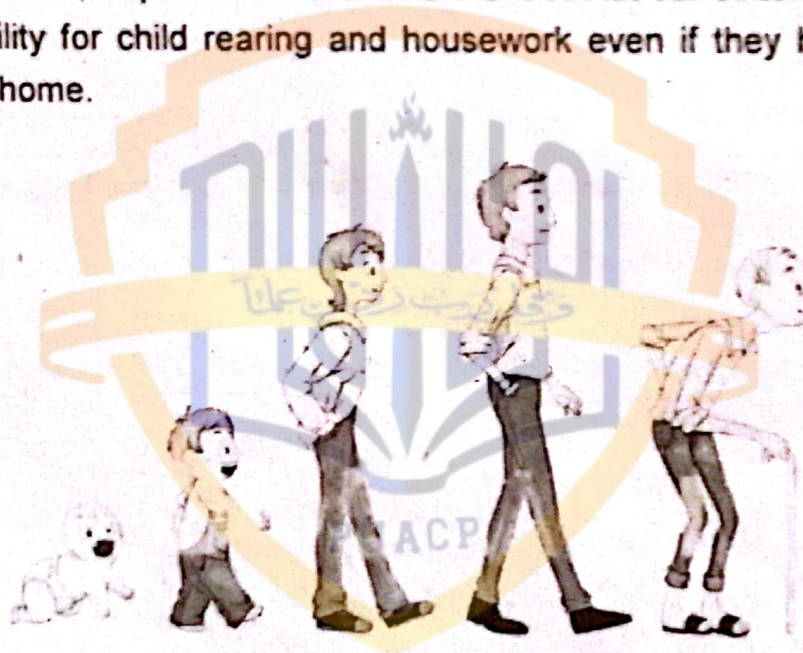
According to WHO, an adult is a person older than 19 years of age.

Adulthood is the time when most of life's accomplishments take place, including pursuing a career and raising a family. Personalities are largely formed by then, although marked changes in a person's environment—such as unemployment, divorce, or serious illness—may cause significant changes to the self.

(i) Early Adulthood

This age is between 19-40 years of age.

During early adulthood—until about age forty—young adults learn to manage day-to-day affairs for themselves, often juggling conflicting. During this stage of life, many women try to "do it all," a pattern that reflects the fact that our culture gives them the major responsibility for child rearing and housework even if they have demanding jobs outside the home.



(ii) Middle Adulthood

In middle adulthood—roughly ages forty to sixty five—people sense that their life circumstances are pretty well set. They also become more aware of the fragility of health, which the young typically take for granted. Women who have spent many years raising a family find middle adulthood emotionally trying. Children grow up and require less attention, and husbands become absorbed in their careers, leaving some women with spaces in their lives that are difficult to fill. Many women who divorce also face serious financial problems. For all these reasons, an increasing

number of women in middle adulthood return to school and seek new careers

For everyone, growing older means experiencing physical decline, a prospect our culture makes especially challenging for women. Because good looks are considered more important for women, the appearance of wrinkles and graying hair can be traumatic. Men have their own particular difficulties as they get older. Some must admit that they are never going to reach earlier career goals. Others realize that the price of career success has been neglect of family or personal health.

4. Old Age

This stage of the life course unofficially begins at the age of 65. Once again, scholars make finer distinctions—such as “young-old” and “old-old”—because of the many differences between people who are 65 or 66 and those who are 85, 86, or even older. Here we will just indicate that old age can be a fulfilling time of life for some people but one filled with anxiety and problems for other people, with social location (social class, race and ethnicity, and gender) once again often making a considerable difference. These problems are compounded by the negative views and even prejudice that many Americans have toward old age and toward people who are old.

EIGHT STAGES OF DEVELOPMENT

Although some analysts (including Freud) point to childhood as the crucial time when personality takes shape, Erik H. Erikson (1902–1994) took a broader view of socialization. He explained that we face challenges throughout the life course.

Stage 1: Infancy—the challenge of trust (versus mistrust). Between birth and about eighteen months, infants face the first of life's challenges: to establish a sense of trust that their world is a safe place. Family members play a key part in how any infant meets this challenge.

Stage 2: Toddlerhood—the challenge of autonomy (versus doubt and shame). The next challenge, up to age three, is to learn skills to cope with the world in a confident way. Failing to gain self-control leads children to doubt their abilities.

Stage 3: Preschool—the challenge of initiative (versus guilt). Four- and five-year-olds must learn to engage their surroundings—including people outside the family—or experience guilt at failing to meet the expectations of parents and others.

Stage 4: Preadolescence—the challenge of industriousness (versus inferiority). Between ages six and thirteen, children enter school, make friends, and strike out on their own more and more. They either feel proud of their accomplishments or fear that they do not measure up.

Stage 5: Adolescence—the challenge of gaining identity (versus confusion). During the teen years, young people struggle to establish their own identity. In part, teenagers identify with others, but they also want to be unique. Almost all teens experience some confusion as they struggle to establish an identity.

Stage 6: Young adulthood—the challenge of intimacy (versus isolation). The challenge for young adults is to form and maintain intimate relationships with others. Falling in love (as well as making close friends) involves balancing the need to bond with the need to have a separate identity.

Stage 7: Middle adulthood—the challenge of making a difference (versus self-absorption). The challenge of middle age is contributing to the lives of others in the family, at work, and in the larger world. Failing at this, people become self-centered, caught up in their own limited concerns.

Stage 8: Old age—the challenge of integrity (versus despair). As the end of life approaches, people hope to look back on what they have accomplished with a sense of integrity and satisfaction. For those who have been self-absorbed, old age brings only a sense of despair over missed opportunities.

Theory of looking glass self:

1. C.H. Cooley

Charles Horton Cooley introduced the *theory of looking-glass self* (1902) to describe how a person's self of self grows out of interactions with others, and he proposed a threefold process for this development: 1) we see how others react to us, 2) we interpret that reaction (typically as positive or negative) and 3) we develop a sense of self based on those interpretations. "Looking-glass" is an archaic term for a mirror, so Cooley theorized that we "see" ourselves when we interact with others.



The Looking Glass Self — In view of Charles H. Cooley, personality is the tendency to adjust our conduct to the conduct of others towards us and he has named this phenomenon by the phrase "the looking-glass self".

"Each to each a looking glass Reflects the other that doth pass"

The idea in self here involves three basic elements: the imagination of our appearance to other person; the imagination of his judgment about that appearance; and self-feelings such as pride inferiority or superiority.

2. G.H. Mead

George Herbert Mead (1863–1931) is considered a founder of symbolic interactionism, though he never published his work on this subject (LaRossa and Reitzes 1993). Mead's student, Herbert Blumer, actually coined the term "symbolic interactionism" and outlined these basic premises: humans interact with things based on meanings ascribed to those things; the ascribed meaning of things comes from our interactions with others and society; the meanings of things are interpreted by a person when dealing with things in specific circumstances (Blumer 1969). This sounds close to Cooley's looking-glass self, but Mead's contribution was really to the development of self, especially in childhood, which we'll discuss in more detail when we address theories of socialization. If you love books, for example, a symbolic interactionist might propose that you learned that books are good or important in the interactions you had with family, friends, school, or church; maybe your family had a special reading time each week, getting your library card was treated as a special event, or bedtime stories were associated with warmth and comfort.

Theory of Self by G.H. Mead:

The Self as I — The rise of the self in the individual is the sum of his personality traits and the total activity of his traits assign him the concept "I". George H. Mead has mentioned two stages in full development of the self. In the first stage, the self of the individual is constituted by the organization of particular attitudes of other individuals towards himself and towards one another. At this stage, the self is also constituted by an organization of the social attitudes of the generalized other or social group or community to which he belongs. Mead holds that if one determines what his position in society is and feels himself as having certain functions and privileges, these are all defined with reference to an "I" but the "I" is not a "me" and cannot become a "me".

The "I" is the organized set of attitudes of others which one he assumes.

Self is a product of socialization in groups — According to Merrill, the self is a product of interaction in a number of group situations. Group situations hold various degrees of reference (importance) upon an individual. Members of the family, neighborhood, playmates, class-fellow, close relatives and friends may form a group by interaction. This group, if most important of all others, bears a lion's share in the emergence and development of his 'self'. Such people in the group, from whom his "self" is reflected, are members of his Reference Group. The individual takes the role of society as a whole towards himself and Mead calls this "taking the role of the generalized other". Generalized other includes the folkways, mores, values and other normative elements of culture. The child slowly becomes conscious of the expectations and begins to judge himself in these terms. Merrill calls a social self 'the core of personality'. Muhammad Fayyaz quotes from George H. Mead about self-system that it is a dynamic system shaping personality with the passage of time.

Self is the core of personality and develops during group life in society. It goes on changing according to the experiences in life. Self creates feelings of love and hatred which are result of human observation and experiences in social life. Therefore, self is a product of social life and emerges during socialization. The type of socialization an individual receives the same type of self he will develop.

Descriptive Questions

1. Define Socialization and explain its importance.
2. Write a note on Agents of Socialization.
3. Define Socialization, also explain process of socialization through the life course.
4. Write a note on theories of C.H. Cooley and G.H. Mead.

Short Questions and Answers

1. **Define socialization.**

Ans.: **Young and Mack observe,** *"the process of inducting the individual into the social world is called socialization"*. In common-sense, socialization is a life-long training for the adjustment of one's life in society. This process of socialization is the process of learning norms, roles, techniques and other cultural patterns. In two ways, the processes of learning take places.

Peter Woeseley: *"process of transmission of culture, the process whereby men learn the rules and practices of social groups."*

2. **Explain importance/functions of socialization.**

- Ans.
1. Learning of social expectation.
 2. Adoption of norms group life.
 3. Development of self.
 4. Better personality development.
 5. Adoption of culture and human skills.
 6. Discipline and training.
 7. Transmission of culture.

3. **Explain agents of socialization.**

Ans.: Agents of socialization are family, friends or peers, social institutions and the community and mass media.

4. **Define primary socialization.**

Ans.: This is the most essential and fundamental type of socialization. It takes place in the early years of newborn baby. At this stage, concentration is given on language and cognitive skills, the internalization of cultural norms and values, establishment of emotionality and appreciation of other roles and perspectives.

5. **Define developmental socialization.**

Ans.: This kind of learning is based on the achievements of primary socialization. It builds on already acquired skills and knowledge as the adult progress through new situations such as marriage or new jobs. These require new expectations, obligations, and roles. This new learning combines with old skills makes possible developmental socialization.

6. **Define anticipatory socialization.**

Ans. Individual not only learns the culture of his groups rather he also learns the cultures of groups to which he does not belong. Such a process whereby men socialize themselves into the culture of a group with the anticipation of joining that group is referred as anticipatory socialization by R.K. Merton.

7. **Define resocialization.**

Ans. Re-socialization takes places mostly when a social role is radically changed. It may also happens during social mobility process. When new social roles emerged which are not compatible with the existing qualities and skills of individual, resocialization takes place. This phenomenon is generally found in old age population who is striving hard for their survival in changing world.

8. **Briefly explain theory of looking glass self CH Cooley.**

Ans. Charles Horton Cooley introduced *the theory of looking-glass self* (1902) to describe how a person's self of self grows out of interactions with others, and he proposed a threefold process for this development: 1) we see how others react to us, 2) we interpret that reaction (typically as positive or negative) and 3) we develop a sense of self based on those interpretations. "Looking-glass" is an archaic term for a mirror, so Cooley theorized that we "see" ourselves when we interact with others.

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9. **Briefly explain theory of GH Mead.**

Ans. *The Self as I* — The rise of the self in the individual is the sum of his personality traits and the total activity of his traits assign him the concept "I". George H. Mead has mentioned two stages in full development of the self. In the first stage, the self of the individual is constituted by the organization of particular attitudes of other individuals towards himself and towards one

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